



Document Development Policy

Policy no:	5.11
Version date	September 2026
Approved by	Senior Management Team
Policy group	Information and Marketing
Version number	V1
Next review due	August 2027
External reference points	Statutory UK GDPR & Data Protection Act, May 2018 Employment Law (Employment Rights Act 1996) The Consumer Rights Act 2015 requires accurate, timely and reliable information, fair terms and conditions and clear, accessible and transparent information. Regulatory - Office for Students (OfS) - B1 Academic Experience - B2 Resources, Support and Engagement - B4 Assessments and Awards - C5 Treating students fairly - E7 Governing Documents and Business Plans See Appendix 3 for TEC's alignment to these OfS Conditions of Registration. UK Quality Code for Higher Education - Principle 7 Designing, developing, approving and modifying programmes - Principle 9 Recruiting, selecting and admitting students - Principle 10 Supporting students to achieve their potential - Principle 11 Teaching learning and assessment - Principle 12 Operating concerns, complaints and appeals processes See Appendix 4 for TEC's alignment to these QAA Principles

Version Control			
Previous Version	New Version	Date	Update/Notes
	V1	Sep 2026	N/a

Contents

1.	Introduction.....	3
2.	Purpose and Scope.....	3
3.	Aims and Objectives.....	3
4.	Document House Style	4
5.	Index of Controlled Documents	4
5.1.	Document or Policy Groups.....	4
6.	Cover Page.....	5
7.	Policy Headings	5
8.	Document Development Procedures.....	6
8.1.	Stage One: Nominating the Author	6
8.2.	Stage Two: First Draft.....	6
8.3.	Stage Three: Approval.....	6
8.3.1.	Chair's Action	7
8.4.	Stage Four: Publication and Circulation.....	7
8.5.	Stage Five: Review	8
8.5.1.	Version Control	8
8.6.	Document Number	8
8.7.	Version Number.....	8
8.8.	Completing the Review Cycle	8
8.9.	Document Development and Review Cycle.....	8
	Appendix 1 Head of Quality Checklist.....	10
	Appendix 2 Chair Action Form	11
	Appendix 3: Alignment with the Office for Students Conditions of Registration	12
	Appendix 4: Alignment with QAA Principles.....	13

Table of Figure

Figure 1 House Style.....	4
Figure 2 Document Development and Review Cycle	9

1. Introduction

This policy sets out the principles, standards and procedures Trent Education Centre (TEC) follows when developing, structuring, formatting, modifying, reviewing, approving, version controlling, storing and publishing its controlled documents. It establishes the requirements for ensuring that all TEC documentation is accurate, up-to-date, consistent and professionally presented.

Although TEC is not yet registered with the Office for Students (OfS), this policy ensures that TEC meets all statutory, regulatory and governance obligations, including those required for OfS registration. It ensures that all required information is communicated effectively, safely and transparently to stakeholders, in compliance with OfS Conditions of Registration, relevant awarding bodies and organisations, partners and accreditation bodies.

2. Purpose and Scope

The purpose of this policy is to provide all stakeholders at TEC with clear information on how TEC develops, manages and controls all organisational documentation. This includes policies and procedures, strategy documents, frameworks, public statements and all controlled documents containing information required by applicants, students, staff, and members of TEC's boards and committees.

This policy identifies who is responsible for drafting these documents, how they must be written and formatted, who reviews and approves them and how they are published and stored. It also establishes how versions of documents are managed and controlled, ensuring that stakeholders have access to accurate, up-to-date information for personal, statutory or regulatory requirements whenever needed.

3. Aims and Objectives

The aim of this policy is to ensure the integrity of all the organisational documentation developed by TEC, enabling it to meet its strategic objectives while minimising governance, academic management, operational, regulatory and reputational risk. It ensures that all documentation is compliant with statutory and regulatory requirements, accurate, complete, consistent and up to date. This policy achieves its aim through the following objectives:

- TEC maintains a full index of all controlled documents, organised into categories and containing details of the document name and number, author, reviewer, approval committee or board, approval date and review date.
- All policies follow a standardised structure, including a cover page, version control table, contents page, footer, footnotes and appendices where relevant.
- All controlled documents follow a clear TEC house style, including consistent formatting, structure and presentational features.
- All policies and other controlled documents are reviewed by their scheduled review dates, with version control tables clearly stating any material changes made to the latest version.
- All policies and other controlled documents are approved by the relevant board or committee before publication or circulation to stakeholders. Where appropriate, documents may be approved through Chair's action, provided they are subsequently ratified at the next available meeting of the relevant board or committee.

4. Document House Style

All policies and some other controlled documents must be formatted in the house style as follows:

Figure 1 House Style

Item	Format
Font colour	Black
Font style	Calibri
Font size for policy title	20 Bold
Font size for headings	14 Bold
Font size for subheading	12 Bold
Font size for sub-subheading	11 Bold
Font size for text	11
Line spacing	1.0
Paragraph alignment	Left (Right unjustified)
Page numbering and footer notes	Calibri 11
Cover page Document Title	Calibri 20
Cover page text (See below)	Calibri 11
Paragraph numbering and sub-numbering	Calibri 11
Example	1 / 1.1 / 1.1.1

All documents must have the TEC logo as follows:



The following is an example of a TEC footer:

Trent Education Centre – Document Development Policy – September 2026 – V1.2

4

5. Index of Controlled Documents

All of TEC's policies, strategies, frameworks, statements, handbooks and other controlled documents are listed in the **Index of Controlled Documents** under one of the following Groups:

5.1. Document or Policy Groups

1. Governance
2. Academic Management
3. Student Admissions and Support
4. Human Resources
5. Information and Marketing
6. Health and Safety, Facilities and Resources
7. Policies for English Language Courses

6. Cover Page

All policies and some other documents have a cover page that includes the Document Title and a table with the Policy number, Version date (Month and Year), Approved by (See Approval Bodies below), Document group (See above), Next review date (Month and Year) and the External reference points related to the document, which are usually relevant legislation or regulation.

Document Development Policy

Policy no:	1.12
Version date	August 2026
Approved by	Board of Governors
Document/Policy group	Governance
Version number	V1
Next review due	August 2027
External reference points	Statutory UK GDPR & Data Protection Act, May 2018 Office for Students (OfS) E7 Governing Documents and Business Plans

7. Policy Headings

All policies have the same first three headings as follows:

1. Introduction

The introduction gives a description of what the policy is and what it includes.

2. Purpose and Scope

The purpose and scope explain why the policy is needed and what range it covers including who, where and when it applies to which activities, practices, behaviours, events or situations.

3. Aims and Objectives

This aims and objectives explain what the policy intends to achieve (aim) and how it will achieve it (objectives).

After these three headings, each policy will have different headings depending upon what the policy covers and what procedures need to be included.

8. Document Development Procedures

All controlled documents including policies are developed in the five-Stage cycle described below.

8.1. Stage One: Nominating the Author

All controlled documents are owned by the Academic Board, Senior Management Team or Board of Governors. The Chair of the Academic Board nominates the author for documents in the Academic Management Group, and the Chair of the Senior Management Team nominates the author for documents in all other groups, including Governance. In some cases, more than one author may be nominated, or the author may delegate authorship to a nominee. The author must create the document in a Word file following the house style described above. The file name must match the document title exactly, with no dates or version numbers included. This ensures that staff do not add dates or version numbers to file names, as all version control is recorded within the document itself.

8.2. Stage Two: First Draft

The required document is first drafted by the author, or their delegated nominee. The author places the document in the **First Draft Folder**, where it can be checked and modified if needed. Relevant stakeholders will normally be given one week to submit any comments to the author, although this period may be adjusted depending on urgency. Only the author or their nominee may make amendments. If there are any disagreements between the author and other stakeholders, the Chair of the approval body's decision will be final.

8.3. Stage Three: Approval

When all stakeholders' comments and modifications have been addressed, the author places a "(Q)" at the end of the document title and informs the Head of Quality. The "(Q)" marker indicates that the document is ready for the final quality check. The Head of Quality then makes a final check to ensure the document meets all the following requirements:

- It has been written in a manner that is appropriate for the audience and the requirements it aims to meet.
- It is compliant with all required statutory and regulatory requirements
- It is accurate, up to date and consistent with TEC's strategic priorities and objectives and aligned with all other TEC documentation and organisational practices
- It is fit for purpose

The Head of Quality may make further amendments before completing the Checklist in Appendix 1. When satisfied, the Head of Quality places the document with the (Q) in the title into the Archive Sub-Folder within the First Draft Folder. The Head of Quality then places a PDF and Word copy of the document into the relevant Approval Body Folder (Academic Board, Senior Management Team, or Board of Governors).

The pdf version of the document is then submitted to the next scheduled meeting of the approval body. The approval body may either:

- Approve the document as it is
- Approve the document on condition of a few amendments
- Return the document to the author (Stage One) for more amendments
- Cancel the document

8.3.1. Chair's Action

If the document is needed urgently and it would be detrimental to delay its publication or circulation until the next scheduled meeting of the approval body, the Head of Quality may submit it to the Chair of the approval body for Chair's Action. The Head of Quality or nominee must complete the **Chair's Action Form** (Appendix 2) and submit it to the Chair of the approval body. The Chair may either:

- Approve the document,
- Refer it back to the Head of Quality or the author for further amendments, or
- Refer it to the relevant approval body for consideration.

In extreme cases where there are serious concerns, the Chair may call an extraordinary meeting to discuss the concerns and if resolved to approve the document. If the document is not approved at this stage, it will be returned to the Head of Quality.

If the Chair approves the document, the Head of Quality places it in the Publication and Circulation Folder and removes the "(Q)" from the title. The document is published and circulated as required but must still be submitted to the next scheduled meeting of the approval body for ratification. If the approval body does not ratify the document, it is returned to the Head of Quality for amendment or cancellation.

8.4. Stage Four: Publication and Circulation

Once the document has been approved by the relevant approval body or through Chair's Action, it may be placed in the **Publication and Circulation Folder**, published on the TEC website if required by the Marketing Staff and a link to the document is circulated to relevant stakeholders. The Head of Quality or nominee must remove the (Q) from the title at this stage and ensure that there is a pdf version of the document for publication and word version stored in the Publication and Circulation Folder. The word version must always be available if any future amendments are required.

8.5. Stage Five: Review

Every controlled document has a review date on the cover page including month and year. The Chair of each approval body must start the review cycle by nominating a reviewer for the document at least two months before the review month. The reviewer must copy the document from the Publication and Circulation Folder into the **Review Folder**. The reviewer must ask relevant stakeholders to review the document and share any comments they may have but only the reviewer may make amendments if needed to the document. As a minimum, the reviewer must update the **Version number** (See below) of the document, the **Version date** and the **Next review due** date. The reviewer must also update the version control table on the cover page(s) of the document (See the Table below).

8.5.1. Version Control

Version Control			
Previous Version	New Version	Date	Update/Notes
V1.3	V2	Sep 2025	N/a
V2 (Sep 25)	V3	Sep 2026	Change made to the section on student loan funding due to changes in SLC government policy.

8.6. Document Number

Controlled documents are numbered according to their Document Group in the Controlled Documents Index. For example, Governance documents are numbered 1.1, 1.2 etc., whereas documents related to Academic Management are numbered 2.1, 2.2 etc. This system continues up to Policies for English Language which are numbered 7.1, 7.2 and so on.

8.7. Version Number

All documents begin at Stage Two as Version 1 (V1). If amendments are required during the approval process or through Chair's Action, the version number increases incrementally (e.g., V1.1, V1.2, V1.3). Once a document has been approved and published, the version number remains unchanged until the scheduled review date. At review, the version number increases to V2, and subsequent amendments during that review cycle follow the same incremental pattern (e.g., V2.1, V2.2).

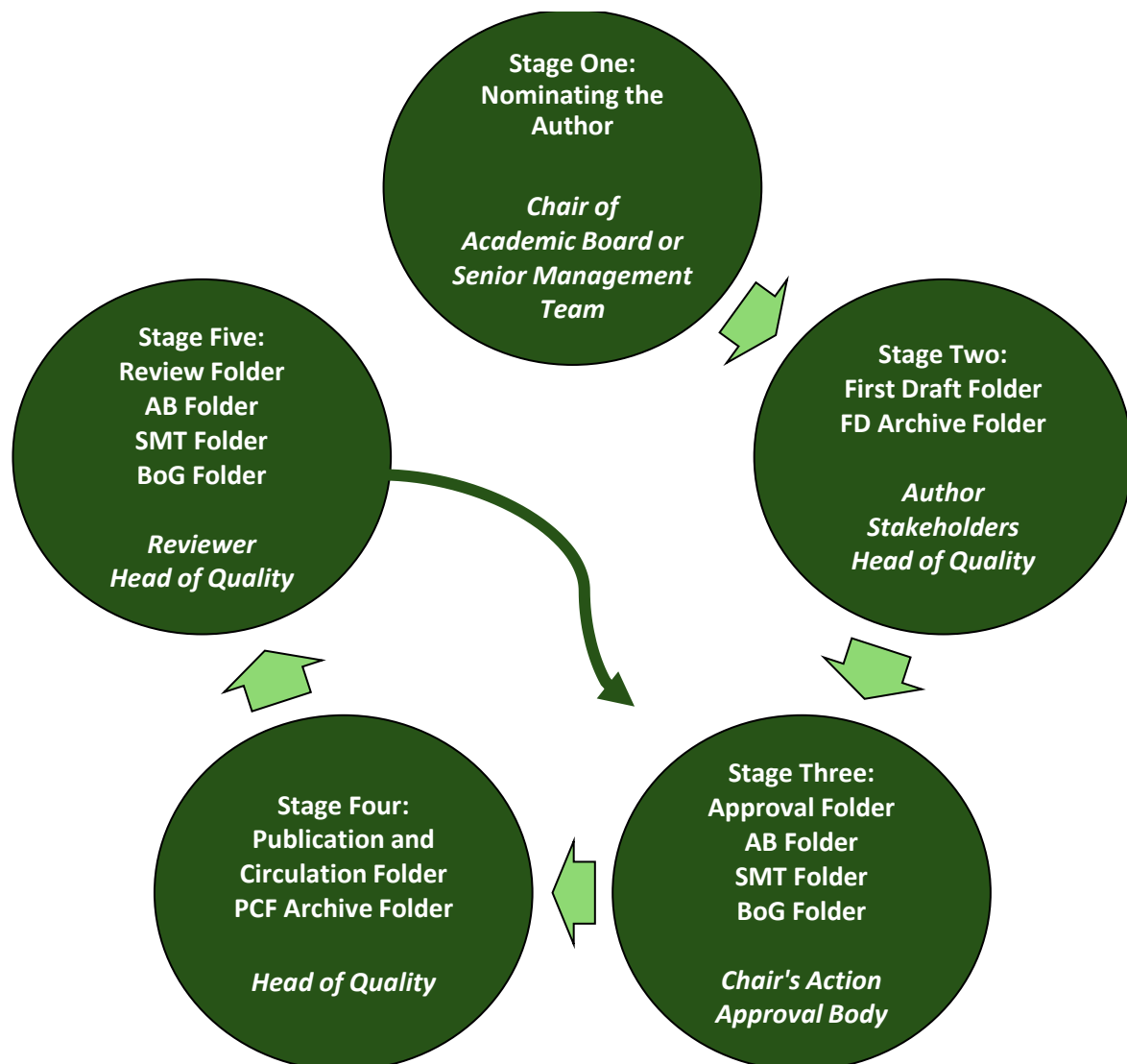
8.8. Completing the Review Cycle

Once the reviewer has completed all required amendments and updated the version number, version date, next review date and version control table, they must place a Word and PDF copy of the document into the relevant Review Sub-Folder (Academic Board, Senior Management Team or Board of Governors) and apply "(QR)" at the end of the document title. The "(QR)" marker indicates that the document has passed the review stage and is ready for the final quality check. The reviewer then informs the Head of Quality. The Head of Quality carries out the final quality check and may make further amendments if required. When satisfied, the Head of Quality moves the document into the relevant Stage Three Approval Body Folder and submits it to the next scheduled meeting of the approval body (or to the Chair for Chair's Action). Once approved, the Head of Quality places the updated document in the Publication and Circulation Folder and ensures that it is published and circulated as required.

8.9. Document Development and Review Cycle

TEC's folder structure supports the five-stage cycle. The First Draft Folder (with Archive Sub-Folder), the Approval Body Folder (with Academic Board (AB), Senior Management Team (SMT) and Board of Governors (BoG) Sub-Folders), the Publication and Circulation Folder (with Archive Sub-Folder) and the Review Folder (with Academic Board (AB), Senior Management Team (SMT) and Board of Governors (BoG) Sub-Folders) each correspond to a specific stage in the process. This structure ensures that documents are stored consistently, traceably and in alignment with the five-stage development and review cycle.

Figure 2 Document Development and Review Cycle



Appendix 1 Head of Quality Checklist

Document Quality Checklist			
Document Title			
Document Group			
Document Number			
Version Number			
Approved by			
Date			
Questions	YES	NO	Comment
Has it been written in a manner that is appropriate for the audience and the requirements it aims to meet?	☐	☐	
Is it compliant with all required statutory and regulatory requirements?	☐	☐	
Is it accurate, up to date and consistent with TEC's strategic priorities and objectives and aligned with all other TEC documentation and organisational practices?	☐	☐	
Is it fit for purpose?	☐	☐	

Appendix 2 Chair Action Form

The Chair of a Board of Committee may approve a document through Chair's action if they can answer YES to all questions in the Chair's Action Form.

Chair's Action Form

Item	Details					
Board / Committee						
Chair						
Date of Chair's Action						
Details of Chair's Action						
	YES	Comments				
Document attached	☐					
The next schedule meeting of the Board or Committee will be too late.	☐					
The document to be approved falls under the authority of the relevant Board or Committee	☐					
The Chair has delegated powers to approve a document from the relevant Board or Committee	☐					
This will be reported to the relevant Board or Committee when it next meets	☐					
Date of ratification						
Outcome	Ratified	☐	Not Ratified	☐	Deferred	☐
Any comments/actions						

Appendix 3: Alignment with the Office for Students Conditions of Registration

This policy is aligned with the following Office for Students Conditions of Registration:

OfS Condition	How it is met at TEC
B1 Academic Experience	Ensuring that policies and procedures, programme specifications, student handbooks, assignment briefs, schemes of work and other controlled documentation that impact on the academic experience are coherent, up-to-date, accurate, consistent and professionally presented.
B2 Resources, Support and Student Engagement	Ensuring that TEC documentation functions as a resource that supports and engages students, including all student-facing information and documentation supporting the activities of the Student Council.
B4 Assessment and Awards	Ensuring that TEC maintains clear academic regulations and assessment-related documentation, including the Assessment Policy, Academic Misconduct Policy and Academic Appeals Policy, enabling students and staff to understand TEC's assessment requirements and processes in compliance with regulators and relevant awarding bodies and organisations
C5 Treating Students Fairly	Ensuring that applicants and students receive accurate, comprehensive and transparent information when joining a course at TEC, including Terms and Conditions, Tuition Fees, Refunds and Compensation Policy, Consumer Protection Policy and Complaints and Appeals Policy.
E7 Governing Documents and Business Plans	Ensuring that appropriate governance documentation is in place, including the Governance and Academic Management Framework (GAMF) and that this documentation is controlled, approved and maintained in line with TEC's governance arrangements.

Appendix 4: Alignment with QAA Principles

This policy is aligned with the following QAA Principles:

QAA Principles	How it is met at TEC	
Principle 7 Designing, developing, approving and modifying programmes	A definitive set of documents are produced from the design, development, approval and modification processes, which are held securely and act as the primary source of information about each programme. Similar but proportionate arrangements are in place for modules and smaller units of study. Policies and processes that support the design, development, approval and modification of programmes and modules are published on each provider's website and are easily accessible to key stakeholders.	TEC produces and maintains a definitive set of programme and module or unit documents through its development, modification, approval and review processes. These documents are stored securely, version-controlled and act as the single authoritative source of information for curriculum content, learning outcomes, assessment and delivery.
Principle 9 Recruiting, selecting and admitting students	Policies and procedures for application, recruitment, selection and admission to programmes are reliable, fair, transparent and accessible.	TEC publishes all its approved academic management policies and procedures on its website, ensuring they are easily accessible to applicants, students, staff, external partners and awarding bodies and organisations. Documentation is clearly organised, consistently formatted and compliant with CMA requirements for clarity and transparency.
Principle 10 Supporting students to achieve their potential	Accessible, relevant, accurate and timely information is offered to students and the staff supporting them throughout the learning journey about the provider, programme of study, wider opportunities for development and availability of support services.	TEC's Admissions Policy and related procedures ensure that application, recruitment, selection and admission processes are reliable, fair, transparent and accessible. Entry requirements, selection criteria and admissions decisions are communicated clearly and consistently, supporting applicants to make informed choices. TEC's Student Support Policy provides clear and accessible information on all the support services TEC provides for students

Principle 11 Teaching learning and assessment	Students are given clear information about the intended modular and/or programme learning outcomes.	TEC provides accessible, accurate and timely information throughout the student journey, including programme and module documentation, student handbooks, assessment regulations, support services information and wider development opportunities. All student-facing information is updated regularly, version-controlled and aligned with CMA consumer protection expectations.
Principle 12 Operating concerns, complaints and appeals processes	Policies and processes for concerns, complaints and appeals are accessible, robust and inclusive.	TEC ensures students receive clear information about programme and module learning outcomes through Programme Specifications, Module Descriptors and assessment documentation. TEC also maintains accessible, robust and inclusive concerns, complaints and appeals processes, published on the website and included in student-facing documentation.